



PHOTOS BY **MANDAR DEODHAR**

5 **L&T** TOP ATTRIBUTES

- FAIR AND OBJECTIVE PROCESSES AND POLICIES
- GROWTH AND LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES
- JOB SECURITY AND STABILITY

◀ **PEOPLE'S MANAGER** C. Jayakumar, Group Chief Human Resources Officer, L&T

All About 'Learning & Training'

L&T provides its employees with a variety of programmes to help them grow professionally and climb the corporate ladder

BY ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

L&T IS AN abbreviation for Larsen & Toubro. But for Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) C. Jayakumar, 58, L&T is all about "learning & training," as the diversified Indian conglomerate, with interests in defence, technology, construction, power, heavy engineering, finance and railways, among others, provides its employees with opportunities to develop skills across segments and climb the corporate ladder.

"Employees at L&T get purpose and pride while working for the company because we make things that make India proud. We are the builders of the nation. We do landmark projects," says Jayakumar, while highlighting L&T projects like the Statue of Unity, Atal Setu, and the Narendra Modi Stadium. "L&T is also called a 'Learning & Training' organisation, as our people get challenging assignments because it is not just one company. There are different businesses and projects within the company and also within India and overseas," he adds.

The company operates 18-19 training institutes across the country, in-

cluding the Leadership Development Academy at Lonavala, which has tie-ups with many marquee institutions including Harvard, INSEAD, and Ross School of Business. The company, in partnership with institutions like the Indian Institutes of Management (IIMs), McKinsey, Ross, and INSEAD, also runs a seven-step leadership development programme to develop future leaders.

But the learning and training part does not end here. The company also has technical training institutes, project management institutes, a rail academy, a tunnel academy that even has its own tunnel boring machine (TBM), and a safety innovation school, among other training centres. Then there is also the Any Time Learning (ATL) programme, which is a digital learning platform that assumed a lot of importance during and after the pandemic. The programme also has tie-ups with other edtech platforms such as Coursera, SkillSoft Percipio, and IPSOS, among others. "Most of the people at the top today in the L&T group are those who have joined and grown with the organisation, and they would have gone through all the developmental initiatives and programmes," adds Jayakumar, who himself has spent close to four decades with the group.

"People [often] ask me how I have been with one company for